

Directions (Questions 1-5): Choose the word which best expresses the meaning of the underlined word in the sentence.

1. Pakistan has been vigorously pursuing a clandestine nuclear weapons programme.
(1) nefarious (2) progressive (3) systematic (4) secretive
2. There was always an imminent danger of the falling of the damaged roof.
(1) constant (2) impending (3) remote (4) favourable
3. His commands were so peremptory that we felt humiliated.
(1) specious (2) poignant (3) dictatorial (4) rough
4. The sentiments expressed by him in the speech were odious.
(1) significant (2) hateful (3) admirable (4) common
5. Everybody laughed at the puerility of his statement.
(1) inaccuracy (2) childishness (3) falsehood (4) insincerity

Directions (Questions 6-10): Choose the word which is closest to the opposite in meaning of the underlined word in the sentence.

6. We should not belittle the value of small things.
(1) expand (2) inflate (3) praise (4) extol
7. The indignation of the retreating troops resulted in large scale killings.
(1) displeasure (2) orderliness (3) happiness (4) anger
8. Merit need not be swamped while filling vacancies through a quota system.
(1) considered (2) raised (3) remembered (4) heeded
9. Joys and tensions are ephemeral aspects of life.
(1) permanent (2) stable (3) spiritual (4) ethical
10. His friends liked everything about him except his frugality.
(1) short temper (2) extravagance (3) shabbiness (4) punctuality

Directions (Questions 11-15): A sentence has been broken into four parts. Choose the part that has an error.

11. (1) Mahatma Gandhi taught us (2) that one should respect
(3) the religions of others (4) as much as his own.
12. (1) He knows very well (2) what is expected from him
(3) but he is not able to (4) fulfill all the expectations.

13. (1) It being rainy day
(3) but to stay at home
(2) we decided not to go out
(4) and watch a movie.
14. (1) The committee appointed to
(3) will convene next week
(2) investigate into the said murder
(4) to further discuss their strategy.
15. (1) India is in no way inferior
(3) in the fertility of soil
(2) than the USA
(4) and in the richness of mineral resources.

Directions (Questions 16-18): Fill in the blanks

16. Though, he is reputed for his technical _____, his books were sadly _____ of the work of others as he lacked originality.
(1) advice, unconscious
(3) knowledge, ignorant
(2) skill, independent
(4) expertise, derivative
17. Nothing is so _____ to a nation as an extreme of self partiality, and the total want of _____ of what others will naturally hope or fear.
(1) detrimental, concern
(3) unethical, discretion
(2) repugnant, sense
(4) fatal, consideration
18. I would like to _____ your attention to the second paragraph of my letter _____ to the terms of sale of the machinery.
(1) invite, according
(3) react, mainly
(2) withdraw, regarding
(4) draw, pertaining

Directions (Questions 19-22): Choose the order of the sentences marked A, B, C, D and E to form a logical paragraph.

19. A After much persuasion, she finally got married.
B She is now a very happy person in life.
C Savi opposed marriage right from her childhood.
D It was her good luck that got a very loving husband.
E But her family was always keen that she must get married.
(1) EBADC (2) CEADB (3) BDACE (4) CDBAE
20. A As she grew up, her interest in music grew manifold.
B Very soon, she started singing in concerts and recorded her own album.
C Today, Sneha is a well known singer of India.
D Sneha had an aptitude for music when she was very young.
E Therefore, her parents organized formal training to learn music for her.
(1) BCDEA (2) AECBD (3) DAEBC (4) CADBE

21. A As soon as the match started, there was much enthusiasm among the spectators.
 B After much effort, Indian team could score a goal just before the final whistle and the match ended in a draw.
 C Indian team was under tremendous pressure.
 D Indian hockey team was quite keen to play a match with Pakistan.
 E But in the first ten minutes, Pakistan scored a goal against India.
 (1) BCEDA (2) DAECB (3) ECDBA (4) AEDCB
22. A Therefore when she rose to become India's Prime Minister, she took several bold decisions.
 B As a result she was mainly responsible to liberate Bangladesh.
 C Today, Indians recognize her as an iron lady.
 D Indira Gandhi was trained by her father the games of politics.
 E During the 1971 Indo-Pak war, she displayed tremendous courage and statesmanship.
 (1) DAEB C (2) CBDAE (3) ECDAB (4) BCEAD

Directions (Questions 23-25): Choose the option which gives the best way of writing the sentence ensuring that the message is correctly conveyed.

23. (1) In spite of his uncanny anticipation, he would have certainly been crushed by the speeding truck.
 (2) Except for his uncanny anticipation, he would have certainly been crushed by the speeding truck.
 (3) But for his uncanny anticipation, he was certainly going to be crushed by the speeding truck.
 (4) But for his uncanny anticipation, he would have certainly been crushed by the speeding truck.
24. (1) Macbeth is a tragedy of a person who was empowered with great qualities.
 (2) Macbeth is a tragedy of a person who was privileged with great qualities.
 (3) Macbeth is a tragedy of a person who was endowed with great qualities.
 (4) Macbeth is a tragedy of a person who was possessed with great qualities.
25. (1) You have come here with a view to insult me.
 (2) You have come here with a view of insulting me.
 (3) You have come here with a view for insulting me.
 (4) You have come here with a view to insulting me.

Directions (Questions 26-30): Out of the sentences given below, only one is correct. Mark the response which in your opinion is correct.

26. (1) Hardly I had reached the station, when the train left.
(2) Hardly had I reached the station then the train left.
(3) Hardly had I reached the station when the train left.
(4) I had hardly reached the station and the train left.
27. (1) He asked his son are you studying seriously for the examination.
(2) He asked his son if he is studying seriously for the examination.
(3) He asked his son whether he is studying seriously for the examination.
(4) He asked his son whether he was studying seriously for the examination.
28. (1) No sooner I entered the classroom, the teacher came.
(2) No sooner I entered the classroom then the teacher came.
(3) No sooner did I entered the classroom than the teacher came.
(4) No sooner did I enter the classroom than the teacher came.
29. (1) The teacher asked the student why he had not done his homework.
(2) The teacher asked the student that why he had not done his homework.
(3) The teacher asked the student why he did not do his homework.
(4) The teacher asked the student that why he did not do his homework.
30. (1) When the child saw the clown, he could not help laughing.
(2) When the child saw the clown, he could not help but laugh.
(3) When the child saw the clown, he could not help but laughing.
(4) When the child saw the clown, he could not but laughing.

Directions (Questions 31-50): Study the passages below and answer the questions that follow each passage.

Passage-I

Competition is heating up on the East coast of India. One of the oldest ports in the country Paradip Port Trust is gearing up to face competition from private sector port giant Adani Ports in Odisha. The state-run Paradip Port Trust held a road show to attract investment of ₹15,100 crore to more than double current capacity to 270.50 million tonnes per annum by 2023. The port will itself be investing another ₹900 crore to aid expansion. The Port Trust said it is open to lease new terminals for both captive as well as commercial operations through the private-public partnership mode. Apart from the six berths in the Western Dock Complex, the port is looking to open new terminals to handle coal, iron ore, petroleum and container cargo. Paradip Port recently introduced a discounting policy based

on the cargo berthed at the port. Our berthing policy is volume centric. More the volumes, more the discount. We are gearing up to face competition. We have to keep fighting, said the Chairman. Adani Ports recent ₹5,500 crore acquisition of Dhamra Port near Paradip Port in Odisha is likely to raise competition in the region. Adani's Mundra Port overtook all ports in Gujarat to become the largest private port operator in the country. Adani Ports is targeting a similar success on the east coast. Paradip Port Trust too wants to become the mother port of India, and plans to mechanise most of the current berths for faster service. We will face competition from Dhamra Port. In the short run, we may be hit but once most of the berths are mechanised, we will be second to none. The timing of Paradip Port's announcement is triggered by someone big coming next door. Cargo growth in the region is going to be significant in the next 10 years and competition for it will not only be between Paradip Port and Dhamra Port. Gopalpur Port, Gangavaram Port and Vizag Port will also take part in it. The eastern hinterland of India, comprising Odisha, Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, is the home to India's vast mineral wealth. With the growth push given by the new government, mining is likely to pick up in the region, aiding cargo movement through coastal routes.

31. Which port has Adani Ports recently acquired in Odisha?

- (1) Gopalpur (2) Dhamra (3) Gangavaram (4) Mundra

32. Which of the following statements are true?

- I. Mining will generate significant cargo growth in the East Coast.
 II. Paradip Port Trust will invest ₹15,100 crore to aid expansion.
 III. Mundra Port is the largest private port operator in the country.

- (1) I and III (2) II and III (3) I and II (4) All these

33. What strategy is the Paradip Port Trust adopting to face competition?

- (1) Mechanise handling operations
 (2) Double current capacity by 2023
 (3) Open new terminals commercially through private-public partnership
 (4) All these

34. Which of the following statements is/are NOT TRUE according to the passage?

- I. In the next 10 years, only Paradip and Dhamra will compete for the cargo growth in the East.
 II. Paradip Port offers volume centric discounts.
 III. Paradip Port Trust has six berths in their Western Dock Complex.

- (1) I only (2) II only (3) III only (4) II and III

Passage-II

The Delhi High Court stopped electric rickshaws from plying on city roads till there was a law to regulate them. The court had reasons to ban the most untamed mode of transport on Delhi roads. Just a day before the order, a toddler had slipped from his mother's arms into a cauldron of hot sugar syrup when she was hit by an e-rickshaw. The court was told that 19 people had been injured and two killed in accidents involving e-rickshaws in the first six months of 2014. At least 1.5 lakh cheap battery-powered rickshaws proliferated on Delhi roads. They ran alongside heavy vehicles on arterial roads. Yet, there were no norms to regulate their movement, speed, design, or even ensure that the vehicles were driven by men who had basic road sense. Now with police crackdown, many have just disappeared from the roads fearing confiscation. The streets may be looking a little less congested and more orderly but the absence of e-rickshaws has hit lakhs of low-budget travellers hard. Travelling by even public transport is not cheap for a large section of Delhi's working class. One needs to shell out ₹40 to ₹50 to cover a distance of three kilometres from home to the nearest metro station on a cycle rickshaw. The e-rickshaw charges ₹20 for the same distance and takes half the time. In Delhi, autos often refuse to go short distances. And even if they do agree, many overcharge. No wonder, the e-rickshaws quickly filled the vacuum of the first and the last-mile connectivity that Delhi and NCR's transport network lacked. But instead of regulating e-rickshaws and integrating them into the city's organised transport system, political parties started pandering to the new political constituency of at least two lakh e-rickshaw drivers, owners and dealers. Initially, the government allowed them to proliferate. Since e-rickshaws were exempted from the regulatory mechanism and needed no permits or fitness certificates, thousands of migrant workers found easy and instant employment. In June this year, it was even declared that e-rickshaws would be out of the ambit of the Motor Vehicles Act. But this move failed to address the concerns of safety and enforcement. Pulling it out of the ambit of Motor Vehicles Act meant the e-rickshaw drivers did not have to undergo any training in driving and road safety rules. The traffic police and transport department couldn't insist that the drivers get a driving licence or a public service badge, which all other motorised public carrier drivers must have. This also meant that the victims of e-rickshaw accidents would not get compensation as mandated under the law. Under the new e-rickshaw scheme, the duties of regulations if any, were to be carried out by the municipal corporations. But municipal officials have neither the expertise nor the wherewithal to handle the road safety aspect. Even the green credentials of these battery vehicles are being questioned by experts. The batteries need electricity to recharge and cases of e-rickshaw drivers stealing from poles, parking lots and public places abound. But having allowed them to run for two years and fill a critical gap in Delhi's public transport system, e-rickshaws can't be wished away. The courts ultimatum is an opportunity to make amends. We need a mechanism that necessitates registration of e-rickshaws, insurance cover, licence for drivers, basic fitness of the vehicle, speed limit, area of operation, designated halting stations and charging points. Tripura has laid down excellent norms for e-rickshaws earlier this year. It should not take Delhi long to adopt that template.

35. What is the primary issue being discussed in the passage?

- (1) E-rickshaws are road safety and environmental hazards.
- (2) Need for a mechanism to regulate and integrate e-rickshaws into Delhi's transport system.
- (3) E-rickshaws — a boon to Delhi commuters.
- (4) Banning of e-rickshaws — the right decision.

36. According to the passage, which of the following statements is/are true?
- Political parties allowed e-rickshaws to proliferate to meet their own electoral objectives.
 - Victims of e-rickshaw accidents get compensation as per law.
 - The absence of e-rickshaws has affected low budget/commuters adversely.
- (1) I and II (2) II and III (3) I and III (4) All these
37. In the opinion of the author, e-rickshaws
- are bad and should not be allowed.
 - are good and should not have been banned.
 - fill a critical gap hence need to be regulated.
 - None of these
38. A proper regulatory mechanism for e rickshaws would ensure
- fitness of the vehicle. (2) safety of the commuter.
 - designated charging points. (4) All these

Passage-III

India's vulnerability to natural disasters can be traced to several geophysical and climatic factors that lead to frequent earthquakes, floods, cyclones and landslides. Recall the earthquakes at Latur, Bhuj or Kashmir, the Leh mudslide and the Uttarakhand floods. The Kosi floods are the latest tragedy to strike us. Then there are the man-caused disasters, these include industrial and biological disasters besides NBC (Nuclear, Biological, Chemical) hazards. We will have to prepare increasingly and more robustly to cope with nuclear disasters, even as it becomes an important source of energy for us. These threats will continue to demand the nation's attention. We need preventive responses so that we can minimize damage to life and property. While the national and state disaster response forces remain designated first respondents and their effective development and specialized equipping should continue at a fast pace. The defence forces, whose organizational resilience, junior leadership, national presence and logistic capabilities are far more developed, need to be given a formal mandate in dealing with these crises. The defence forces, by and large, have been second responders unless they are in geographical proximity of the disaster area, in the eye of the storm itself or when the impact area is large or remote. They de facto become first responders when the area in question requires acclimatization — Leh and upper reaches of Uttarakhand are examples of this terrain. Defence services personnel who themselves become victims of these disasters when serving in affected areas have shown immense resilience. They set aside their own troubles to reach out to the affected population. There are glorious examples of armed forces heroes who chose to attend to victims who were perfect strangers instead of first ensuring the safety of their near and dear ones. These stories have been heard time and again during the tsunami relief operations in 2004, the Kosi floods in 2008, Cyclone Aila relief work in 2009, the Leh cloud burst in 2010, the Sikkim earthquake in 2011, the Uttarakhand disaster and Cyclone Phalin in 2013. The threats a nation faces don't necessarily have to relate to the infringement of its land or coastal borders or its air space. Any factor that affects the security and survivability of its people are a national threat. The harm caused by natural, or potential manmade disasters are as terrible as those caused by an adversary's armoury. As

a national asset, with the role of protecting the nation and its people, combating the challenge of disasters should also fall within the charter of the defence forces. India's defence forces have often come to the assistance of other nations reeling under natural disasters. Not many may know this but the assistance given by Indian military to foreign nations coping with various natural and manmade crises has been received with a lot of appreciation – Cyclone Nargis in Myanmar, the Chinese earthquake in 2008, the medical emergency in Sri Lanka in 2009 and 2011, the recent MH 370 disaster in Indian Ocean in March 2014 and Typhoon Haiyan in Philippines in November in 2013 are only a few of these examples. It is not a question of grabbing credit. The aim is to strengthen the purpose of the military to serve the people. All national assets and resources should face the emergent challenge as “we”, not ‘I’ or ‘you’ as agencies are generally prone to. Using the defence services to deal with disasters will help us harness the ‘total assets’ of the nation. It has a pan-national presence, and its logistics and leadership are tried and tested. It will also help us provide maximum relief.

39. What is main purpose of the passage?

- (1) To recommend that the defence forces must be given a formal role in disaster management.
- (2) To highlight the exemplary support provided by defence personnel in relief operations.
- (3) To identify likely disaster prone areas.
- (4) To correlate natural disaster with other threats to national security.

40. According to the author, the defence forces should be formally entrusted with the responsibility of disaster management because

- (1) it is a national asset and should therefore be harnessed.
- (2) units are located in all parts of the country.
- (3) it strengthens the purpose of the military which is to protect the nation and the people.
- (4) All these

41. According to the writer, the defence forces are suited to perform the role because

- (1) their leadership is tried and tested.
- (2) their logistic capabilities are far more developed.
- (3) defence services personnel are disciplined, motivated and resilient.
- (4) All these

42. Which of the following statements are true?

- I. During disasters, affected armed forces personnel have time and again reached out to help others, notwithstanding their own problems.
- II. Any factor that affects the security and survivability of its people is a national threat.
- III. National and State Disaster Response Forces are designated as the first respondents in the event of any natural calamity.

- (1) I and II
- (2) II and III
- (3) I and III
- (4) All these

Passage-IV

We have come a long way since the acronym 'BRIC' was coined in 2001. Emerging markets are now an integral part of the world map and this elite group of nations has firmly positioned itself as an important catalyst driving global growth. However, these economies too are vulnerable to global hitches, as was evident in 2011 when most emerging markets, including India, China, and Brazil witnessed a drop of over 18% even as developed economies like the US registered a growth of 5% against all odds. The first three weeks of 2012 have caught everyone off guard with emerging markets racing ahead of their developed counterparts. From being one of the worst performers in 2011, India has rallied by more than 9.5% followed by Brazil (7%) and China (6.9%). While such a momentum may not be sustainable over a longer horizon, no one can ignore the fact that the combined population of China, India, Brazil and Indonesia amounting to 3 billion or 43% of the global population will drive consumption demand in these markets for decades to come. Secondly, these countries do not have to face certain critical issues that the developed world has to address. One of the critical challenges for developed economies relate to entitlement issues, as they struggle to take care of their citizens' needs pertaining to health care and unemployment. While analysing growth trends in these economies, it is important to understand the difference in terms of the nature of the growth. Emerging markets are moving along a natural growth trajectory, driven by several factors as mentioned above, whereas developed markets are being forced to induce growth through various stimulus measures amid a scenario of peaking unemployment and near-nadir consumer confidence levels. This induced growth in a way also helps the cause of emerging markets since most of these economies derive a substantial portion of their GDP from exports.

43. It can be inferred from the passage that "BRIC" is a/an
- (1) grouping of the world's topmost economies.
 - (2) grouping of the world's emerging economies.
 - (3) economic term that was tossed out of use in the year 2001.
 - (4) None of these
44. According to the author of the passage, emerging economies of the world
- A are going to increase their impact on the global economy in times to come.
B are having roller-coaster rides as far as their economies are concerned.
C are not committed to providing healthcare and employment opportunities to their citizens to the extent that the leading economies of the world are.
- (1) A only (2) A & B (3) A & C (4) A, B & C
45. Which of the following factors equally affect both the developed and developing economies, as specifically implied in the passage?
- A Recession.
B Unemployment.
C Natural growth tendency of the economy.
- (1) A & B (2) A only (3) A & C (4) A, B & C

46. Which of the following statements is/are true as per the passage?

- (1) Induced economic growth in the developed countries indirectly helps economic growth in the developing countries.
- (2) When developed economies are experiencing growth, the developing economies experience decline and vice versa.
- (3) Both (1) and (2)
- (4) Neither (1) nor (2)

Passage-V

Pharma giant GSK illustrates how devastating fraud can be to a company. The Chinese government has accused the company and its executives, including the former head of GSK China, of funnelling hundreds of millions of dollars in bribes to doctors and health officials. This has forced GSK to terminate a number of senior executives. GSK is hardly the only company battling corruption. In one year, Walmart India suspended several executives at its joint venture with Bharti, including its CFO and CEO, as it examined potential violations of US anti-bribery laws. Cadbury India is being investigated for alleged bribery by US authorities. Adidas India terminated and pressed criminal charges against its country manager and other senior executives accusing them of defrauding the company of over \$150 million. These are not shabby companies. They had implemented all the basics: a code of conduct, written policies, tight controls et al. Yet, they fell victim to fraud by their own senior leaders. Increasingly the biggest corruption risk companies may face is not that they will have to pay bribes or speed money to government officials but that many of their own employees may be on the take. Partly that's because of the rising pressure on financial performance; the temptation to cook the books, stuff the channel with inventory and make side agreements with customers and partners is great. Greed is also driving more management fraud. Accepting kickbacks from vendors and advertising agencies, commissions on real estate transactions or machinery purchases, a deposit in an overseas bank on the successful acquisition or sale of a company — these are becoming routine. It's not just multinational companies that are victims of employee fraud. Indian companies are too. It's just that MNCs have home country anti-bribery laws that are more stringently enforced. Companies must take multiple precautions to inoculate themselves against the risk of employee fraud. To start with, ensure the basics are in place. Have you instituted a formal code of conduct with mandatory training for every employee and annual re-certification? How is the company's code of conduct communicated to customers, dealers and vendors? Do vendors know the entertainment and travel reimbursement policies of the company? Does the company have a strong internal audit team and a competent fraud investigation unit? How does the company deal with a problem? Is investigation swift and punishment decisive, fair, and public?

Clear policies, procedures with approval processes and stringent controls, regular internal audits of high-risk areas and so on are all necessary measures, but what really matters is strong leadership and a culture of compliance. The tone set by local leadership is critical, especially in our hierarchical culture. A zero-tolerance policy is vital. Few companies discuss the character of leaders during hiring or performance appraisal; hitting the numbers is almost all that really matters. However, companies must pay attention to the small things, like segregation of personal phone calls, appropriateness of business expenses, lifestyle and addiction to status symbols and the personal use of company assets. A sense of entitlement in small things is often a predictor of bigger problems.

An open and non-hierarchical culture is also important. In most cases, employees are aware of

suspicious conduct long before it is officially discovered but they won't blow the whistle if they don't feel safe in coming forward or if they don't believe that top management is serious about punishing wrong doing. When it comes to ethics and compliance, culture and leadership really matter. The CEO has to ensure that every employee in every part of the world is utterly clear about what conduct is acceptable and what is not. In too many companies, when fraud is discovered, the response is shock and dismay; middle managers and front-line employees are conveniently made scapegoats. Life quickly goes on.

Globalisation today is fundamentally about expanding into emerging markets. Whilst these markets are dynamic and filled with talent and opportunity, many are also unfortunately very corrupt societies. Dealing with corruption is a new core competency that no global company can afford to do without.

47. What is the main area of concern and the issue focused on in this passage?
- (1) Dealing with corrupt government officials.
 - (2) Dealing with leadership deficiencies.
 - (3) Dealing with increasing internal fraud.
 - (4) Dealing with globalization issues.
48. According to the passage, which of the following statements is True?
- I. GSK, Walmart and Adidas had written policies and tight controls yet become victims of fraud.
 - II. Misuse of minor perks is a pre-cursor to major problems.
 - III. Accepting benefits from vendors is becoming routine.
- (1) I and II only (2) II and III only (3) I and III only (4) All these
49. According to the passage, which of the following statements is Not True?
- (1) The character of leaders is discussed by very few companies during hiring.
 - (2) When fraud is discovered, action is invariably taken against the top management.
 - (3) While internal audits are necessary, strong leadership and a compliance culture is what matters.
 - (4) None of these
50. In order to prevent internal fraud, companies should
- (1) communicate the formal code of conduct to all employees and others dealing with them.
 - (2) have a strong internal audit and fraud investigation mechanism.
 - (3) take prompt, fair, decisive and transparent action against defaulters.
 - (4) All these
51. What is the value of A:B:C, if A:B = 2:3 and B:C = 4:5?
- (1) 8:12:15 (2) 2:3:4 (3) 2:3:5 (4) 4:6:11
52. A certain sum of money is divided among A, B and C so that for each rupee A has, B has 65 paise and C has 35 paise. If B's share is ₹1300, then total sum of money is
- (1) ₹7000 (2) ₹6000 (3) ₹5000 (4) ₹4000

53. A can do a work in 20 days and B can do in 10 days. A starts the work and works alone for 5 days. Then B joins A and they finish the work. In how many days the work gets finished?
 (1) 10 (2) 12 (3) 9 (4) 8
54. Reema took a loan of ₹ 120000 on simple interest for as many years as the rate of interest. If she paid ₹58800 as interest at the end of the loan period, then the rate of interest is
 (1) 6% (2) 7% (3) 8% (4) 9%
55. A box contains 7 green, 6 black and 4 yellow balls. How many selections are possible so that we have one ball of each colour.
 (1) 138 (2) 168 (3) 148 (4) 17
56. Rakesh gives ₹140000 to Ramesh for a business. Ramesh spends $\frac{1}{8}$ of his profit on rent of shop. If they are left with equal amount, what is investment of Ramesh?
 (1) ₹160000 (2) ₹150000 (3) ₹170000 (4) ₹180000
57. On enquiring her age by a friend, Shikha told her that fifteen years from now, she will be twice as old as she was five years ago. What was her age five years ago?
 (1) 16 years (2) 20 years (3) 25 years (4) 32 years
58. The price of sugar falls by 15%. How many quintals can be bought for the same money which was sufficient to buy 34 quintals at the higher price?
 (1) 40 quintals (2) 38 quintals (3) 35 quintals (4) 43 quintals
59. The average of nine consecutive odd integers is 11. Then the largest of these integers is _____.
 (1) 17 (2) 19 (3) 21 (4) 15
60. A boat covers the distance between two cities I and II, which are 10 km apart and comes back in river I in 50 min. and same distance in river II in 75 min. If the speed of boat in still water is 30 km/h, what is the ratio of speed of river I and river II?
 (1) 3:5 (2) 2:3 (3) 1:1 (4) 1:2

Directions (Questions 61-65): Study the following arrangement carefully and answer the questions given below :

RE5DAP\$3TIQ79B#2K%U1MW4*J8N

61. Which of the following is exactly in the middle between 3 and 1 in the above arrangement?
 (1) B (2) K (3) 9 (4) #

62. How many such numbers are there in the above arrangement, each of which is immediately preceded by a consonant and not immediately followed by a consonant?
 (1) None (2) One (3) Two (4) Three
63. How many such vowels are there in the above arrangement, each of which is immediately followed by a number but not immediately preceded by a consonant?
 (1) None (2) One (3) Two (4) Three
64. Which of the following is seventh to the left of the sixteenth from the left in the above arrangement?
 (1) A (2) U (3) 4 (4) T
65. Four of the following five are alike in a certain way based on their position in the above arrangement and so form a group. Which is the one that does not belong to that group?
 (1) B K 7 (2) M * U (3) D P E (4) W J 1

Directions (Questions 66-68): Each of these questions has statements followed by two conclusions I and II. Decide which of the conclusions follows from the statements.

Mark the answer as:

- (1) if conclusion I follows.
 (2) if conclusion II follows.
 (3) if neither conclusion I nor II follows.
 (4) if both conclusions I and II follow.

66. **Statement :** Space has no gravitational pull. It has no atmosphere.

Conclusions:

- I. Gravity is due to atmospheric pressure.
 II. It is not difficult to breathe in space.

67. **Statement :** Computer literates have good reasoning ability. Seema can understand the puzzle quickly.

Conclusions:

- I. Seema is computer literate.
 II. Seema has good reasoning ability.

68. **Statement :** Evaporations cause cooling. Coke is very cold.

Conclusions:

- I. Some of the coke must have evaporated.
 II. Coke offered in this restaurant is very cold.

Directions (Questions 69-71): In the following questions, two statements have been given, which bear a cause and effect relationship. Mark the answer as:

- (1) if Statement I is the 'Cause' and the Statement II is its Effect.
- (2) if Statement II is the 'Cause' and the Statement I is its 'Effect'.
- (3) if both Statements I and II are 'Effects' of a common 'Cause'.
- (4) if both Statements I and II are 'Effects' of independent Causes.

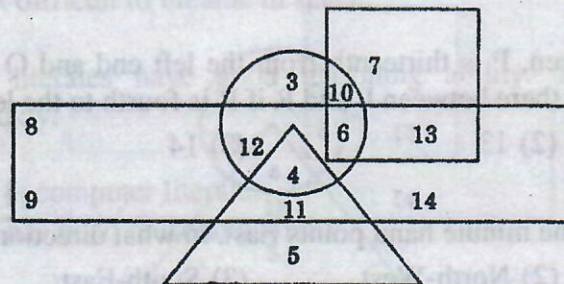
69. **Statement I:** The Times of India has reported today that water of Ganga at Varanasi contains level of pollutant much higher than the permissible limit.
Statement II: The people living in the area are to be shifted to another area to avoid a catastrophic situation.
70. **Statement I:** The Government has planned to make arrangements for supply of safe drinking water from Tehri Dam.
Statement II: The Ganga water at Kanpur is not even fit for bathing as it contains very high level of pollutants.
71. **Statement I:** The internet users of the country have been advised to stay alert while using internet till the hackers are caught.
Statement II: The Government machinery will make an all out effort to catch those who are responsible for hacking and put in place a sound internet security system for all its websites.
72. Sudeep said to Rajeev, "The man watching TV is one of the two brothers of the daughter of my father's wife". How the man watching TV is related to Sudeep?
(1) Brother (2) Brother-in-law (3) Cousin (4) Uncle
73. In a row of forty children, P is thirteenth from the left end and Q is ninth from the right end. How many children are there between P and R if R is fourth to the left of Q?
(1) 12 (2) 13 (3) 14 (4) 15
74. A watch reads 4.30. If the minute hand points East, in what direction will the hour hand point?
(1) North (2) North-West (3) South-East (4) North-East
75. One day, Ravi left home and cycled 10 km southwards, turned right and cycled 5 km and turned right and cycled 10 km and turned left and cycled 10 km. How many kilometres will he have to cycle to reach his home straight?
(1) 10 km (2) 15 km (3) 20 km (4) 25 km

Directions (Questions 76-80): Read the following information to answer these questions.

There are six teachers A, B, C, D, E and F in a school. Each of the teachers teaches two subjects, one compulsory subject and the other optional subject. D's optional subject was History while three others have it as compulsory subject. E and F have Physics as one of their subjects. F's compulsory subject is Mathematics which is an optional subject of both C and E. History and English are A's subjects but in terms of compulsory and optional subjects, they are just reverse of those of D's. Chemistry is an optional subject of only one of them. The only female teacher in the school has English as her compulsory subject.

76. What is C's compulsory subject?
 (1) History (2) Physics (3) English (4) Chemistry
77. Who is a female member in the group?
 (1) A (2) B (3) C (4) D
78. Which of the following has same compulsory and optional subjects as those of F's?
 (1) D (2) B (3) A (4) None of these
79. Disregarding which is the compulsory and which is the optional subject, who has the same two subject combinations as F?
 (1) A (2) B (3) E (4) D
80. Which of the following groups has History as the compulsory subject?
 (1) A, C, D (2) B, C, D (3) C, D (4) A, B, C

Directions (Questions 81-85): The following questions are based on the diagram given below



- i. Rectangle represents males
 iii. Circle represents urban
 ii. Triangle represents educated
 iv. Square represents civil servants
81. Who among the following is an educated male who is not an urban resident?
 (1) 4 (2) 5 (3) 9 (4) 11

82. Who among the following is neither a civil servant nor educated but is urban and not a male?
 (1) 2 (2) 3 (3) 6 (4) 10
83. Who among the following is a female, urban resident and also a civil servant?
 (1) 6 (2) 7 (3) 10 (4) 13
84. Who among the following is an educated male who hails from urban area?
 (1) 4 (2) 2 (3) 11 (4) 5
85. Who among the following is uneducated and also an urban male?
 (1) 2 (2) 3 (3) 11 (4) 12
86. 'EVARA' is a popular _____ jewellery brand.
 (1) silver (2) diamond (3) platinum (4) gold
87. 'Cherokee', the global fashion lifestyle brand tied up with which one of the following Indian companies?
 (1) Aditya Birla Group (2) Arvind Mills (3) Reliance Retail (4) ITC Group
88. _____ covers the entire gamut of women's prêt-a porter from western to fusion to Indian silhouettes. Churidar-kurtas, tunics and saris form the matrix of the Indian designs.
 (1) Jamdani (2) Taika (3) Dastar (4) Mufti
89. 'home centre', the high-gloss living popular brand is from the house of
 (1) Bombay Dyeing. (2) Raymond. (3) Lifestyle. (4) None of these
90. 'Mayur Suitings', the famous Indian suiting brand is from the house of
 (1) Bhilwara Group. (2) Dinesh Mills Ltd. (3) Arvind Limited. (4) Mafatlal Ind. Ltd.
91. The raised zari metallic thread embroidery created by sewing flat stitches on cotton padding is commonly known in India as
 (1) Kantha. (2) Karchobi. (3) Kasuti. (4) Kathi.
92. Who among the following tops the philanthropy list of India in 2014 according to the annual Hurun India Philanthropy list 2014?
 (1) Shiv Nadar (2) Ratan Tata
 (3) Azim Premji (4) Mukesh Ambani

93. FieldFresh Foods is a joint venture between processed food manufacturer Del Monte Pacific and
 (1) Bharti Ent. (2) PespiCo. (3) Parle Agro. (4) Dabur.
94. Which one of the following hotels from India was voted as the best hotel in the world in 2014 in a global poll conducted by financial magazine Institutional Investor, USA?
 (1) The Leela Palace Udaipur (2) The Oberoi, Mumbai
 (3) The ITC Grand Chola, Chennai (4) The Taj Palace Hotel, New Delhi
95. Recently, the Nepal Govt. reduced the climbing fees for Everest from earlier fee of \$25,000 to _____ for each foreign climber via the normal route in spring.
 (1) \$ 20,000 (2) \$ 16,000 (3) \$ 11,000 (4) \$ 22,000
96. Which among the following telecom companies started the pre-booking for Xiaomi Redmi Note 4G smart phone in January 2015?
 (1) Idea Telecom (2) Bharti Airtel (3) Reliance Telecom (4) Vodafone
97. Justice Surendra Kumar Sinha became the 21st Chief Justice of _____ in January 2015 for three years.
 (1) Nepal (2) Mauritius (3) Indonesia (4) Bangladesh
98. Who among the following Indian fashion designers introduced 'Kurti' which became popular worldwide as 'Indian embroidered tunic'?
 (1) Ritu Kumar (2) Monisha Jaisingh (3) Suneet Verma (4) Rohit Khosla
99. 'Creyate', the custom clothing e-commerce brand is owned by which textile firm from India?
 (1) Arvind Limited (2) Grasim Industries (3) Bombay Dyeing (4) Century Textiles
100. 'Mafrere Saris', the popular sari brand is from the house of
 (1) Reliance Industries. (2) Mysore Silk.
 (3) Mafatlal Ind. Ltd. (4) National Textile Corporation.
101. Who among the following fashion designers presented the 'GULBAGH' collection at the Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week Summer-Spring 2015?
 (1) Manish Arora (2) JJ Valaya (3) Tarun Tahiliani (4) Rohit Bal

102. 'The designer MODE', is the official magazine of
 (1) Fashion Design Council of India.
 (2) The Confederation of Indian Textile Industry.
 (3) National Institute of Fashion Technology.
 (4) None of these
103. Lakme Fashion Week Summer/Resort 2014 took place in ____ 2014.
 (1) January (2) February (3) March (4) April
104. 'Tamas' and 'nimah' are the jewellery collections from the house of
 (1) Kalyan Jewellers. (2) Amrapali Jewels.
 (3) Gitanjali Jewels. (4) Joyalukkas Jewellers.
105. As per the history of Indian clothing, who is said to have bought Indigo (Nila) for dyeing and cotton cloth as articles of clothing to India?
 (1) Greeks (2) Romans (3) Dutch (4) French
106. As per the history of Indian clothing, a plain woven textile made from unbleached and often not fully processed cotton traded to England was called
 (1) Chintz. (2) Calico. (3) Muslin. (4) None of these
107. As per the history of Indian Art, the Jaipur style was inspired by which school of art?
 (1) Hyderabad (2) Bengal (3) Mughal (4) Pahari
108. As per Indian History most of the Gandhara sculptures are made of
 (1) Stone. (2) Terracotta. (3) Bronze. (4) Iron.
109. Which trinity of Gods does the three-faced sculpture of Shiva in the Elephanta caves signify?
 (1) Brahma, Vishnu, Mahesh (2) Kali, Durga, Sita
 (3) Ganesh, Ram, Krishna (4) Brahma, Vishnu, Indra
110. Which artist made "Jahangir holding the picture of Madonna"?
 (1) Miskin (2) Abul Hassan (3) Mansoor (4) Hazi Madni

Directions (Question 111-130): Read the following cases and answer the questions given at the end of each case on the basis of information provided.

Case-I

In a first step to protect brand 'Khadi', a symbol of India's struggle for Independence, the Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) has applied for registration of the trademark in India before moving to claim the international trademark, the MSME Ministry said. The move follows reports of the 'Khadi' trademark already being registered in Germany, Spain, Hungary and in India. In a written reply to a question by an MP in the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for MSME said "the process to register international trademark for 'Khadi' for intellectual property rights under the World Intellectual Property Organisation's Madrid Protocol is of two stages; first, at the national and subsequently at the international level. KVIC has applied to register the trademark for 'Khadi' under appropriate classes." Asked if the Government was facing a trademark hurdle in countries where it had already been registered, Minister said the issue was brought to the Government's notice by the Indian Embassies in Germany, Poland, Belgium, Luxembourg and the European Union, as also by traders and merchant exporters who were not able to market 'Khadi' products there. Incidentally, 'Khadi' has already been registered by a German company (Khadi Nature product GbR) as a trademark, with the Office for Harmonization in the Internal Market in Spain, giving it exclusive rights for use of the term. The Minister said that while KVIC was not directly exporting Khadi products, "Indian Embassies were in touch with the EU authorities for cancellation of registration of Khadi as a trademark and the only available means to cancel the registration is through a request for declaration of invalidity or of revocation..." Minister said that the Government, KVIC and Indian Embassies were working in tandem to expedite the process of deregistering the 'khadi' trademark, adding that KVIC, Mumbai, had authorised Swati Gramudyog Sewa Sansthan, Kanpur, "to file for deregistering the trademark along with requisite fees, which has been filed".

111. Presently, KVIC has

- (1) been exporting Khadi products in a big way directly.
- (2) not exported Khadi products directly.
- (3) been exporting only high quality Khadi products.
- (4) not encouraged exporting Khadi products.

112. According to reports, which of the following countries has registered Khadi as trademark?

- (1) Hungry (2) Germany (3) Spain (4) All these

113. Which of the following statements is not true as per the facts of the case?

- (1) KVIC intends to register Khadi as a brand at the international level
- (2) Government of India does not consider Khadi has any association with India's Freedom Struggle.
- (3) Presently, it is difficult to market Khadi products in some countries.
- (4) None of these

Case-II

Godrej Appliances Division has undertaken an initiative to ensure a green supply chain at its Shirwal plant in Satara, Maharashtra. One of the largest players in the home appliances segment, the Godrej group has consistently manufactured products that are green. Though Godrej Appliances launched the country's first 100 per cent green refrigerator series in 2002, (CFC, HFC and HCFC free), the company's Shirwal plant aims to ensure a lower toxic environmental impact with its products. The plant has four refrigerator manufacturing lines and a separate line for making the Chotukool, dubbed the cheapest refrigerator in the country. Chairman and Managing Director of Godrej and Boyce Manufacturing Company, spoke at a recent event about several ongoing green programmes at Godrej. Godrej and Boyce is the holding company of the Godrej Group, and has 14 diverse businesses. The company's 'Good & Green Vision 2020' aims to ensure 25 per cent reduction in energy consumption, achieve zero waste and carbon neutrality, and have one-third of its portfolio revenues comprise green products and services. Jamshyd Godrej said, manufactured products will need to be green and the future of any product will be a blend of satisfaction and sustainability. The future of products and manufacturing would soon be to serve a higher level of needs for consumers. Catering to the higher level doesn't mean more expensive, it should bring a higher level of satisfaction. At Godrej's Shirwal plant, several initiatives have been taken towards material conservation and increasing the percentage of recycled material. An official said the percentage of recyclable content in refrigerators, washing machines and air-conditioners has been increased to 97 per cent, and 100 per cent, respectively. The plant has reduced the use of packaging material by 21 per cent in the last three years, by switching from carton packaging to stretch film packaging. The unit has also taken several initiatives to reduce the consumption of toxic and hazardous substances by an average of 50 per cent.

114. Godrej aims to Cater for higher level of needs of customers, which implies making items which are
- | | |
|----------------------|------------------------------|
| (1) more costly. | (2) having attractive looks. |
| (3) more satisfying. | (4) None of these |
115. By the year 2020, Godrej plans to ensure
- | | |
|------------------------|---|
| (1) zero waste. | (2) 25% reduction in consumption of energy. |
| (3) carbon neutrality. | (4) All these |
116. At Godrej's plant at Shirwal, constant efforts have been made to increase the percentage of recycled material and the progress made in this regard has been
- | | |
|------------------------------|--------------------------|
| (1) not at all satisfactory. | (2) just about adequate. |
| (3) almost satisfactory. | (4) quite good. |
117. As per the case, which of the following statements is 'not true'?
- | |
|--|
| (1) Godrej is the largest player in the home appliance segment in India. |
| (2) Godrej and Boyce are involved in numerous business activities. |
| (3) By using stretch film packaging, the use of packaging material has been reduced. |
| (4) None of these |

Case-III

Eureka Forbes, leader in the ₹3,800-crore water purification systems market, is betting big on 'customised solutions' to expand its footprint. Eureka Forbes has mapped the water quality in over 85 per cent of India's pin codes over the last 15 years. "This holds us in good stead in offering solutions for over 17 different types of water conditions in the country so far," said Senior Vice-President (Marketing), Eureka Forbes Ltd. It recently moved up the value chain from just 'pure' to position its products on the 'health' platform, with its new tagline 'More than just pure. Healthy water'. Based on its internal feed-back system, the company undertakes various research programmes across the country to understand the needs of different sets of consumers. Over the last 30 years, Aquaguard has invested heavily in research and technology to understand customer needs and customise solutions and products to suit every water type in India. For instance, it has launched mobile water purifier Aquaguard-on-the-Go, he said. Eureka Forbes is expanding its retail network to cover tier-II and tier-III markets. Initially, a pure-play direct sales company, it now has a significant presence in retail, franchised, rural, institutional community, and e-tail platforms. VP says the rural market holds high growth potential, particularly for off-line water purifiers, and "we have come out with a new range of affordable purification units for rural markets." It has set up water kiosks in several tier II and tier III towns that sell water at 15 paise a litre. So far, it has established over to 200 such kiosks in the country. It also proposes to set up such kiosks in major cities including Chennai, Bangalore, Mumbai and Kolkata. But it may not sell a litre at 15 paise, as cost of running those kiosks in major cities will be much higher. "We are planning to do some pilots before we launch them," he said. The market for water purifiers in the country is growing at 15 per cent year on year. Many homegrown and global brands have jumped into the fray. "We welcome all competition. It fuels innovation and eventually that will benefit the consumer," says VP.

118. Eureka Forbes is focusing on rural market due to the fact that
- (1) it holds tremendous growth potential.
 - (2) Eureka Forbes plans to provide pure water at a reasonable price to rural areas.
 - (3) it has already made units for rural markets.
 - (4) All these
119. Eureka Forbes has made efforts to study quality of water in various locations and
- (1) has covered only some areas.
 - (2) these efforts have not been much successful.
 - (3) has already covered a large area of the country.
 - (4) None of these
120. Consequent to research to observe needs of various category of people, Eureka Forbes now plans to offer
- | | |
|------------------------------|---------------------------|
| (1) generic solutions. | (2) customized solutions. |
| (3) one-time solutions only. | (4) one solution for all. |

Case-IV

The fragmented home appliances category is poised for consolidation, with companies looking for acquisitions to strengthen their manufacturing capabilities and expand operations into newer areas. Early this year, the Netherlands based Royal Philips Electronics had acquired Tamil Nadu based Preethi, makers of mixers and grinders. In May, France's Groupe SEB bought out the 45 per cent stake of Maharaja Whiteline in order to take full control of the company. Market leader Bajaj Electricals is now scouting for acquisitions to make a mark in the non-electrical kitchen appliance space, while new entrant Borosil is seeking a foothold in manufacturing with the help of smaller companies. "We want to strengthen our position in the non-electrical kitchen appliance space like pressure cookers, gas stoves and non-stick cookware, for which we are open to acquiring smaller companies in these categories," says Executive Director, Bajaj Electricals. Earlier, some of these items were reserved for the small scale sector. Bajaj Electricals said it is looking for players who make and brand these products to add them to its roster of kitchen and small appliances. The company continues to sell the largest number of mixer grinders (2.5 million a year) and irons (at 3.5 million) in the country. Bajaj Electricals has a research and development centre in Mumbai, but most of its home appliances are out-sourced to third party players. With a sales turnover of ₹1,500 crore from the home appliance division, Bajaj Electricals has already tapped into the premium end of the category with its imported Morphy Richards brand. The mass-end comprises its own brand of Bajaj, with appliances ranging from sandwich makers to water heaters. Borosil, which has recently entered the home appliance category, is also eager to acquire smaller players with manufacturing capabilities. Glassware maker Borosil's foray into home appliances is expected to get a leg-up with potential acquisitions. "We have set aside a budget of ₹150 crore for acquisitions. Since we do not have our own manufacturing facilities, we will look at small companies with manufacturing facilities in categories like tableware and crockery. An acquisition will ensure a position of strength and know-how in the kitchen appliance category," says Managing Director, Borosil Glass Works. Considering that the company already has 14,000 outlets for its glass works, it would use the same for some of its kitchen appliances such as mixer grinders. "Once you start your own manufacturing, it helps in building the kitchen appliance business further," MD, Borosil Glass Works adds.

121. Borosil, which is basically a glassware maker, presently

- (1) has huge manufacturing facilities of their own.
- (2) has just a few manufacturing units of their own.
- (3) does not have manufacturing units belonging to it.
- (4) None of these

122. To market its kitchen appliances, Borosil plans to

- (1) open a large number of outlets in all parts of India.
- (2) open only a few outlets in selected towns.
- (3) open big outlets only in Metro cities.
- (4) utilise its existing outlets.

123. Bajaj Electricals is currently planning to
- (1) expand its existing business of selling electrical appliances.
 - (2) come out of its business of dealing with electrical appliances.
 - (3) enter into selling non-electrical kitchen appliances.
 - (4) close down its business altogether.

Case-V

Despite softer consumer sentiment, global diamond major De Beers Group said its brand Forevermark has seen rapid growth in India. CEO, Forevermark, part of the De Beers Group of Companies, said: "Forevermark has had a fantastic year in India. Despite the overall slow economy and slow sales, we have nearly doubled sales and are growing strongly." The Forevermark brand is available across 22 key cities in the country and the company is looking to expand in new cities, in partnership with leading jewellery retailers. India has been a success story for the diamond industry, as it is a major diamond centre for cutting and polishing of all qualities and sizes and has a huge skill base, said CEO, speaking on the sidelines of the World Diamond Conference, which was attended by both Russian President and Prime Minister. "What is perhaps less known is the extraordinary growth of India as a consumer of diamond jewellery. Over the last decade, we have seen a big increase in the percentage of diamond jewellery purchases, making India and China the two fastest growing markets," he said. CEO said this is due to the growing capacity of the upper middle-class to buy diamonds. The company recently conducted an extensive consumer study that showed growth in consumption and purchases of diamond jewellery in India in the past decade. India is the third largest diamond consumer, in terms of value, among the top countries. "Of the diamonds that we sell overall, about 10 per cent are sold to Indian consumers. Of course, nearly nine out of 10 diamonds from our mines are cut and polished in India. We are optimistic about the opportunity offered by the economic growth in India," CEO added.

124. Which of the following would be considered the fastest growing market(s) for diamonds in the world?

(1) US (2) China (3) India (4) Both (2) and (3)

125. Presently, in the diamond business, India is known for which of the following?

(1) Cutting diamonds
(2) Polishing diamonds
(3) Having a large number of skilled workforce to deal with diamonds.
(4) All these

126. Currently, almost _____ of diamonds sold by De Beers Group are sold to Indian customers.

(1) one fifth (2) one tenth (3) one fourth (4) one third

127. Which of the following statements is *not true* as per the facts of the case?

- (1) Most diamonds sold are cut and polished in India.
- (2) During the last year, De Beers Group increased their sales marginally only.
- (3) Forevermark brand is planning to expand its retail outlets in India.
- (4) None of these

Case-VI

Sharp rises in cost and slowing demand are forcing diamond traders to adopt technology not only to sell diamond jewellery but also to source rough diamonds. Israel headquartered Segoma Imaging Technologies, which provides three dimension imaging solutions for diamond traders across the world, has set up a lab with 20 scanning machines in Bharat Diamond Bourse in Mumbai and photographs about 100 diamonds a day. The company intends to open a similar lab in Surat, and has plans to mark its presence in Hong Kong and Belgium within a year. Segoma is in the process of producing another 100 machines, which cost about \$10,000 (Rs 6 lakh) a piece. Once the diamond is put into the scanning machine, developed in-house by Segoma, high quality images demonstrate all the properties of a diamond — cut, colour, clarity and transparency. Each picture with a unique code is a complete visual substitute for the physical inspection of a diamond. Founded by three entrepreneurs, Segoma has big global diamond mining companies such Rio Tinto and De Beers among the 1,750 registered users in India, Israel and the US. It also provides a trading platform to auction scanned diamonds. The company charges between \$3 and \$50 per piece depending on size. Speaking to media, cofounder and CEO, Segoma Imaging Technologies said presence in India was inevitable as the country, on average, processes eight of the ten diamonds sold worldwide. “The diamond industry would not only save huge costs on transportation and insurance but also reduce the lead time in executing deals. It will also eliminate unwanted expenses incurred in shipping back the goods in case of rejection and open the market for traders,” CEO said. In India, Segoma has tied up with the diamond certification body, International Gemological, Institute. Asked if traders would buy diamonds by seeing an image, CEO said most of the traders, especially in India, are very professional and have been running the business for generations. If they are not convinced, CEO added, the company would not have managed to photograph 4 lakh diamonds in last two years.

128. After opening its lab in Mumbai, Segoma is planning to open similar labs in which of the following locations in the near future?

- (1) Belgium
- (2) Hong Kong
- (3) Surat
- (4) All these

129. Presently, number of diamonds, which are sold worldwide, but processed in India is

- (1) not really much.
- (2) considered quite low.
- (3) really huge.
- (4) quite negligible.

130. Which of the following is considered an advantage of inspecting diamonds by Segoma Imaging?

- (1) Reducing costs
- (2) Expeditious finalization of deals
- (3) Provision of trading platforms for dealers
- (4) All these

Directions (Questions 131-150): Each of these questions has a statement based on the preceding passage. Evaluate each statement and mark answer as

- (1) if the statement is a Major Objective in making the decision: one of the goals sought by the decision maker.
- (2) if the statement is a Major Factor in making the decision: an aspect of the problem, specifically mentioned in the passage, which fundamentally affects and/or determines the decision.
- (3) if the statement is a Minor Factor in making the decision: a less important element bearing on or affecting a Major Factor, rather than a Major Objective directly.
- (4) if the statement is a Major Assumption in making the decision: a projection or supposition arrived at by the decision maker before considering the factor and alternative.

Passage-I

India, one of the fastest-growing ecommerce markets, is expected to have 100 million online shoppers by 2016 when the industry will grow to \$15 billion, or about ₹93,000 crore, up from 35 million consumers and \$3-billion valuation this year, according to a recent Google report. Yet, in a highly competitive marketplace, where big discounts are the primary sales drivers for online retailers, many small players are struggling to gain ground. "For every successful online retailer, there are at least 10 others which have either shut shop or got acquired," said chief executive at retail consultancy Third Eyesight. He said just selling at lower rates isn't enough for small players at a time large players flushed with funds aggressively look to grab market share through deep discounting. "Smaller players should have some key differentiator so that customers can give business to them instead of competition," he said. In fact, with small players forced to match discounts offered by bigger rivals, most of these firms reported higher losses, some even posting half their overall sales as net loss. VAS Services, which runs Yepme portal, posted a net loss of ₹45 crore on net sales of ₹61 crore last fiscal, while the net loss of Shopclues at ₹38 crore was higher than its net sales of ₹30.5 crore. But investors are still upbeat about ecommerce players, due to the huge growth opportunity. "Investors are still willing to pay fairly healthy valuations for some of the smaller players in the market," said an investor who has backed a private label e-tailer. Fashion and You, a flash sales site of Delhi-based Goldsquare sales, also managed to reduce losses to ₹20 crore in FY14 from ₹77.9 crore in the previous year as it consolidated its business after acquiring fashion and beauty e-tailor urbantouch a year ago. "The focus throughout the year was to bring efficiency and cut down cost that included trimming down the employees from 1,000 to 300 people," said CEO of Fashion and You, which posted a 21% decline in sales at ₹75 crore due to the reorganisation.

131. India, one of the fastest growing ecommerce markets is expected to have 100 million online shoppers by 2016.
132. In a highly competitive marketplace, big discounts are the primary sales drivers for online retailers.
133. Smaller players should have some key differentiator so that customers can give business to them.
134. Investors are still upbeat about ecommerce players, due to the huge growth opportunity.
135. The focus throughout the year was to bring efficiency and cut down cost that included trimming down the employees from 1000 to 300 people.

Passage-II

The Centre has decided to recast the boards governing trade of commodities such as tea, coffee and spices to make them more performance oriented and accountable at a time when global competition is fast intensifying. The move, which will involve amendment of archaic Acts to make the boards more responsive to contemporary challenges comes after commerce & industry minister felt that these boards need to improve their working and achieve specific results in promoting exports. There have been reports of closure of several tea plantations in West Bengal and Assam, home to Darjeeling tea and Assam tea. The department of commerce is working on amendment of the Tea and Coffee Acts, which date back to 1942 and 1953 respectively. "We are planning to update Acts for tea and coffee to streamline framework of operations. They are very old. We want greater decentralisation of powers and simplifications of systems," said the official, who did not wish to be identified. The commodity boards for tea, coffee, rubber, spices, tobacco, etc. working under the commerce department are responsible for not only carrying out export promotion but also developing the domestic industry. They have offices in India as well as abroad. Tea Board is concentrated in Kolkata, prompting the government to decentralise its operations and give powers to other centres such as Guwahati and Coonoor. This will help bring in more players into the market, making it easier to obtain licences. While boards do not directly export, they regulate the sector, register exporters and give licenses. The government is also trying to scale up incentives for marketing and export promotion. The manufacturers will need to comply with the Plant Protection Code from next year and procure a certificate of complying with the standard. The government is also working on an insurance based scheme for stabilisation of prices of four plantation based crops — tea, coffee, rubber and spices. Another official involved in the exercise cited the example of Coffee Board, saying the body has not been able to boost exports even as it has supported domestic trade primarily because it lacks the vision required to succeed in international markets.

136. The Centre has decided to recast the boards governing trade of commodities such as tea, coffee and spices to make them more performance oriented.
137. The move involves amendment of archaic acts to make the boards more responsive to contemporary challenges.
138. We are planning to update Acts for tea and coffee to streamline framework of operations.
139. This will help bring in more players into the market.
140. Board lacks the vision required to succeed in international markets.

Passage-III

India is proposing to set up a dedicated dispute resolution unit for expeditious disposal of transfer pricing cases that have in the past few years evoked strong reaction from domestic and International investors, with some dubbing this 'tax terrorism'. Through this measure, the new government hopes to send out strong signals of a non-adversarial and investment friendly tax regime. "We are proposing to create a separate vertical for a dispute resolution panel with dedicated manpower. This will be a big step," revenue secretary said at an international tax conference held by the Confederation of Indian Industry recently. Transfer pricing refers to the pricing of assets, tangible and intangible, services, and funds transferred within an organisation in a cross-border transaction. Tax administrations usually apply stringent rules to prevent transfer of income from high-tax jurisdictions to low-tax ones through such pricing to escape or lower tax. The proposed resolution units will have dedicated manpower dealing with these issues, free from the pressure of revenue targets. Such

attempts were not successful earlier because officials had to also keep an eye on revenues while making transfer pricing decisions. He said, the government is looking at various taxpayer friendly measures aimed at improving the overall business environment in the country as also to give it an edge. "We are carrying forward the tax reform agenda in line with the "Make in India" initiative. Tax reforms are needed to lend competitive advantage to India," he said, adding that a number of instructions aimed at reducing litigation among others had already been issued. "We have asked tax authorities that high pitched assessments without proper basis must be avoided. Also, if a case is taken up for scrutiny, then assessing officers have been asked to raise queries only related to that subject and not to indulge in fishing (expeditions)," he said. He also pointed out that a separate vertical has been created to deal with income tax exemptions to ensure that they are utilized properly in line with their inherent objective. "The whole effort is to change the thinking and functioning of the department. It has to be an enabling department. We are looking to expand 24x7 customs clearances for ease of doing business," he said.

141. India is proposing to set up a dedicated dispute resolution unit for expeditious disposal of transfer pricing cases.
142. Tax administration applies stringent rules to prevent transfer of income from high tax jurisdictions to low tax ones.
143. Officials had to also keep an eye on revenues while making transfer pricing decisions.
144. Tax reforms are needed to lend competitive advantage to India.
145. The whole effort is to change the thinking and functioning of the department.

Passage-IV

Several companies that deliver shipments for online retailers are bearing the brunt of the upheaval in India's aviation sector, as cancellation of dozens of flights by beleaguered airline SpiceJet and a decline in air cargo space for commercial shipments throws delivery schedules into disarray. These logistics companies — many of which focus solely on India's booming ecommerce sector — are afraid. The situation will only worsen in the coming year, as airlines battling rough weather offer first preference to passengers over cargo in the crowded holiday season. "The trouble with an aviation player (SpiceJet) has aggravated the situation," said, chief executive officer and cofounder of Bengaluru-based DotZot, the e-commerce shipment arm of logistics firm DTDC Ltd. "It has hit shipments especially to parts of Northeast where shipments are being delayed." Other affected logistics firms include Ecom Express, Delhivery and Gojavas. SpiceJet cancelled about 100 flights. This has disrupted ecommerce shipments to cities like Chennai and Hyderabad where SpiceJet offered good air connectivity from Delhi and Mumbai. "About 80% of the e-commerce shipments in India now travel by air," said, managing director of retail consultancy Wazir Advisors who estimates that logistics companies delivering online retail shipments don't use road or rail often. "Due to the shrinking air cargo hold, larger players will have to get together to buy dedicated aircraft for e-commerce shipments", he said. This month, shipments have also been delayed due to fog and increase in passenger luggage which is mostly composed of winter wear, thus reducing air cargo space. "The industry was already under pressure after Kingfisher downed shutters. With SpiceJet also under trouble, there will be delay in shipments out of Delhi," said, CEO of Ecom Express, a Gurgaon based e-commerce logistics player. Online retailers said, they are firming up plans to deal with the issue by increasing sellers within a city. "We pick up and drop in same city to optimise operational efficiency," said, cofounder and CEO of fashion portal Fashionara. The portal has opened hubs in six

cities to deal with logistical bottlenecks. Consumers, who have been flocking to online websites in search of deep discounts, could now find prices shooting up as portals pass-on the increase in delivery costs. "In case an airline goes down completely, we might see prices going up". At present airlines charge about ₹90 per shipment from ecommerce players. Industry estimates indicate that airlines transported about 2.12 lakh tonnes of freight generated by the ecommerce industry this year compared to 1.96 lakh tonnes in fiscal 2013.

146. There is a decline in air cargo space for commercial shipments.

147. Airlines battling rough weather offer first preference to passengers over cargo.

148. SpiceJet cancelled about 100 flights last week.

149. Larger players will have to get together to buy dedicated aircraft for e-commerce shipments.

150. Consumers could now find prices shooting up.